

2026**English****Full Marks: 50****Pass Marks: 17****Time: 2 hours***(The figures in the margin indicate full marks for the questions)***Allotment of Marks****Section – A : Unseen Passage**

Q. No. 1 carries 8 marks

2+2+2+1+1 = 8**Total = 8****Section – B : Advanced Writing Skills**

Q. Nos. 2 & 3 carry 5 marks each

5×2 = 10**Total = 10****Section – C : Grammar**

Q. No. 4 carries 1 mark each

1×3 = 3

Q. No. 5 carries 1 mark each

1×2 = 2

Q. No. 6 carries 1 mark each

1×2 = 2

Q. No. 7 carries 1 mark each

1×2 = 2**Total = 9****Section – D : Text Book**

Q. No. 8 carries 1 mark each

1×5 = 5

Q. No. 9 carries 2 marks each

2×3 = 6

Q. No. 10 carries 4 marks

4×1 = 4

Q. No. 11 carries 2 marks each

2×2 = 4

Q. No. 12 carries 2 marks each

2×2 = 4**Total = 23****Turn Over**

Section – A : Unseen Passage (Marks - 8)

1. Read the passage carefully and answer the following questions: **8**

The next time you take printouts unnecessarily or you throw a paper into the bin, think for a minute as to how many trees have been felled to manufacture something you use so often every day.

Can you take out some time from your everyday routine and devote it to starting a simple recycling programme at your school or your neighbourhood? Not only you would save our planet from the torture of felling greenery, but also you would reduce generation and dumping of waste into the environment.

Using recycled papers conserves natural resources. As our population grows, the strain on these resources becomes even greater. You can drastically reduce the number of trees cut down for manufacturing paper. In addition to saving landfill space, you cut down on your expenses of trash-disposal.

There is a reduction in air pollution caused by incineration. Making papers from discards instead of trees not only saves forest, but it also reduces energy used by up to three quarters and requires less than half as much water. Items that are made of paper and may be recycled are called the loose paper, a few examples are paper bags, magazines, newspapers, cardboard and egg-trays.

Working on a paper recycling plant demonstrates the concept of recycling waste into 'wealth'. Recycling paper will help to keep the environment green. If we keep our minds focused on the desire to be friendly to our earth and its resources, recycling will become important. Parents can teach their children the importance of recycled paper by bringing about simple changes in their lifestyle. Schools can also train up students to make paper products like folders, penholders, TLMS and various paper crafts.

On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer the following questions:

- (a)** What do you need to think before you take printouts unnecessarily? **2**
- (b)** Name some of the products that can be obtained from recycled paper. **2**
- (c)** How does recycled paper conserve natural resources? **2**
- (d)** Give the antonym of *conserve*. **1**
- (e)** Find a word in the passage which means "the destruction of something, especially waste material by burning". **1**

Section – B : Advanced Writing Skills (Marks - 10)

2. You are the editor of your school/college magazine. Write a notice for your school/college notice board inviting articles for the school/college magazine. (Word limit – 50) **5**

Or

You are Rima/Rajiv, a resident of Tinsukia. You have lost your file folder containing important documents while travelling from Tinsukia to Jorhat. Draft an advertisement in not more than 50 words for publication in an English Daily giving details. **5**

Turn Over

[3]

3. Write a factual description of the exhibition-cum-sale programme organised by the school recently. 5

Or

Write a letter to the Editor of 'The Assam Tribune' highlighting the rising prices of essential commodities and their impact on common people, with the aim of drawing the attention of the concerned authorities.

Section – C : Grammar (Marks - 9)

4. Rewrite the following sentences with the correct form of verbs given in brackets : (Any three) $1 \times 3 = 3$

- (a) The boy (sleep), don't disturb him.
- (b) Perhaps it (rain) yesterday.
- (c) We reached the station after the train (leave).
- (d) If I (be) you, I would not do that.
- (e) He (work) here since 2009.

5. Fill in the blanks with appropriate preposition : (Any two) $1 \times 2 = 2$

- (a) What is the time ____ your watch?
- (b) She takes pride ____ his wealth.
- (c) I am very much interested ____ your story.
- (d) Man is superior ____ animal.
- (e) The police ran ____ the thief.

6. Change the voice of the following sentences: (Any two) $1 \times 2 = 2$

- (a) My umbrella has been broken.
- (b) They laughed at us.
- (c) Shut the window.
- (d) Who discovered America?
- (e) The coach is training the players.

7. Change the form of narration in the following sentences: (Any one) 2

- (a) My friend told me that he was very thirsty and requested me to give him a glass of water.
- (b) One day Mukesh said to me, "I will be a motor mechanic and leave Firozabad." I said to him, "Do you know anything about car?"

Section – D : Text Book (Marks – 23)

8. Answer the following questions: (Any five) $1 \times 5 = 5$

- (a) Why did Gandhi visit Lucknow in 1916?
- (b) Where is Champaran situated?
- (c) Where did Gandhi and Shukla board a train to?
- (d) What does the author of 'Lost Spring' find Saheb doing every morning?
- (e) Where was the original home of Saheb's family?
- (f) What are mahseers?
- (g) Who is the Chota Sahib in the 'Memoirs of a Chota Sahib'?

9. Answer any three questions in 30-40 words: $2 \times 3 = 6$

- (a) "Garbage to them is gold". What does 'garbage' mean to the elders and children, according to Anees Jung?

Turn Over

[5]

- (b) Why was Gandhi impressed with Shukla?
- (c) What information does the author give us about Manas Wild Life Sanctuary?
- (d) How was Gandhi able to influence the lawyers? Give instances.
- (e) What is the irony inherent in Saheb's full name?
- (f) What is Firozabad famous for and why?

10. Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow:

(i) "Now we will count to twelve
and we will all keep still,
For once on the face of the Earth
let's not speak in any language,
let's stop for one second,
and not move our arms so much."

- (a) How long does the poet want to stay still? 1
- (b) Why does he ask us to keep still and not use any language? 2
- (c) What does the poet mean by "not move our arms so much"? 1

Or

(ii) "Driving from my parent's
home to Cochin last Friday
morning, I saw my mother,
beside me,
doze, open mouthed,
ashen like that of a corpse..."

- (a) Where was the speaker driving to? 1
- (b) What did she notice when her mother sat beside her? 1
- (c) Find two words from the passage that mean "sleep lightly" and "a dead body". 1
- (d) Why was her mother's face like that of a corpse? 1

11. Answer the following questions: (Any two) 2×2=4

- (a) What is the 'sadness' that the poet refers to in the poem 'Keeping Quiet'?
- (b) What is the 'childish longing' that the poet refers to? Why is it 'vain'?
- (c) How did the travellers on the highways react to the roadside stand?
- (d) What childhood fear did Kamala Das refer to in the poem 'My Mother at Sixty-Six'? How did she hide it?

12. Answer any two of the following questions: 2×2=4

- (a) What did the astrologer predict about the Tiger King?
- (b) Who is the Tiger King? Why did he get that name?
- (c) How did the Tiger King celebrate the killing of the hundredth tiger?